

India. Audio systems, car infotainment systems, handsets, cellular communications, telecommunications, and medical imaging and diagnostics are just a few examples that touch the common man's life every day. With rapid evolution of these technologies, the opportunities only continue to grow.

Srinivas says, "With all major OEMs having design and development centres in India, I believe the job scenario in DSP and associated systems is very good." "DSP is a specialised field in high technology. So work in this domain rates high in job satisfaction," he adds.

"In the wireless and media space, DSP skills are needed in two areas – codecs development and optimisation, and physical-layer development," informs Milind Gandhe, business line head, semiconductor & silicon platforms, Sasken.

He says, "Demand for codec development and optimisation is now declining, but the demand for physical layer (Layer 1) development is quite high. These are niche areas and there are not too many experts available with these skills. As a result, the career prospects are quite bright."

"With the rise of DSP related applications in today's electronics, a natural consequence is increasing work in the field of DSP," believes Subodh Shukla, engineering group director, Cadence Design Systems (India). There is substantial amount of DSP in most of the commonly used devices like cell phones, DVD/CD players, portable music devices and TVs.

He says, "There is a lot of DSP work happening in India. Historically, India has a long tradition of DSP – when the first semiconductor companies approached India over 20 years ago, the teams were involved in DSP. Over the years, India has built up expertise in DSP, which is recognised globally. Therefore a lot of the outsourced work to India in embedded systems/chip design area is in DSP."

Also, with IT booming in India, there is a lot of demand for jobs in the DSP field in India, believes Jiju George, director-human resources at Broadcom. He informs, "The scope of career in this field would be in sectors such as defense, telecom, multimedia, medical instrumentation, low-cost smart devices, space and aviation, consumer electronics, automotive and safety products."

Qualification

To make a career in DSP field, one typically needs to have a graduate degree in electronics engineering or electronics and communication engineering. A postgraduate degree in signal processing is preferred, informs Gandhe.

For DSP chip or system design, a master's degree in electronics or associated domain is desirable.

"Writing DSP software requires good grasp of signal processing concepts. Therefore a master's degree in electronics or computer science with specialisation in DSP would be highly preferred," explains Giri.

Kaushal believes that a good idea of design algorithm,

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